Alex P. Leith, PhD

Curriculum Vitae

Associate Professor (Tenured), Mass Communications, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville
Founder & Principal Research Consultant, SIM-DAD LLC

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Academic Appointments

Associate Professor (Tenured 2025) — Director, AURA Lab @ SIUE Department of Mass Communications, College of Arts & Sciences, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville (SIUE), Edwardsville, IL · Aug 2025 – present

AURA Lab (Avatars, Users, Relationships, and Affect Lab) — rebranded May 2026 from the former SIM Lab (Social & Interactive Media Lab) — is a computational communication research group at SIUE studying how people form relationships, perform identity, and experience affect across virtual environments, streaming platforms, and digital media. Affiliated with the Beyond Meet Space (BMS) initiative on virtual presence and remote work, a multi-institutional research partnership.

Assistant Professor (Tenure-track) Department of Mass Communications, College of Arts & Sciences, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville (SIUE), Edwardsville, IL · Aug 2019 – Jul 2025

Additional Academic & Teaching Appointments

Adjunct Instructor: Southern Illinois University Edwardsville — Aug–Dec 2011; St. Louis College of Pharmacy — Aug 2011 – May 2012; McKendree University — Jan–May 2012

Graduate Training / Graduate Appointments

Graduate Assistant, Michigan State University — Sep 2012 – May 2017 Graduate Assistant, Southern Illinois University Edwardsville — Aug 2010 – May 2011

Industry & Consulting Experience

Founder & Principal Research Consultant — SIM-DAD LLC Independent research and data consulting practice | Remote · Jun 2024 – present

Applied behavioral research, UX/user research, and data analytics consulting for technology, media, and gaming clients.

Develops a suite of local-first, privacy-preserving research and authoring tools: GearOut runs in production at SIUE, TASS and Lector are in closed beta, and the others are in development. All processing runs on the user's machine; no cloud dependency, no per-token metering.

- **TASS** (Text Analysis & Sentiment System) — dictionary-based text analysis on open, citable dictionaries, with statistical group comparisons and APA-cited exports. Open-core: the Community Edition engine, CLI, and MCP server are Apache-2.0 (github.com/SIM-DAD/tass); the no-code Windows desktop application is commercial. usetass.app
- **GearOut** — equipment reservation and checkout platform for universities; Next.js / TypeScript / PostgreSQL production web application, deployed at SIUE as *MassComm Checkout*. Sole developer.
- **Ibis** — fully offline audio transcription for Windows. useibis.app

- **Lector** — authoring environment with integrated text-to-speech. uselector.app
- **Orator** — converts documents into locally voiced narrated video. useorator.app
- **Resero** — the workbench that houses the suite. useresero.app

Marketing Manager — Brigham Young University–Idaho Marketing & Communications | Rexburg, ID · Aug 2008 – Aug 2009

Education

Doctor of Philosophy, Information and Media (Media and Information) · 2019 Michigan State University *Dissertation:* Gameplay livestreaming: Agents of gamespace *Committee:* Rabindra Ratan (Chair), Casey O'Donnell, Morgan Ellithorpe, Brandon Van Der Heide

Master of Arts, Speech Communication (Interpersonal Communication) · 2011 Southern Illinois University Edwardsville *Thesis:* I know what you did last night: Exploring parasocial Facebook relationships *Committee:* Jocelyn DeGroot-Brown (Chair), Alicia Alexander, E. Duff Wrobbel

Bachelor of Arts, Communication (Public Relations) · 2009 Brigham Young University – Idaho *Clusters:* English and Philosophy

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Publications

Leith, A. P., Lim, C., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., & Jeong, D. (2025). Stress and coping in VRChat: A mixed-method case study of the use of VRChat as a coping tool during the COVID-19 pandemic. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports, 20*(100843). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2025.100843

Bouzek, D., Foxman, M., Lim, C., & Leith, A. P. (2025). Balancing fun and professionalism in game development: the dark and light side of play in virtual meetings. *Frontiers in Communication, 10*. https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomm.2025.1609776

Ratan, R. A., Lin, Q., Lim, C., Park, R., Lover, A., Han, E., Jang, D., Leith, A. P., & Bailenson, J. N. (2025). Time matters in VR: Students benefit from longer VR class duration, but certain outcomes decline after 45 minutes, with large individual variance. *Computers & Education, 235*, 105328. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compedu.2025.105328

Lim, C., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R., Foxman, M., & Bouzek, D. (2025). Meeting needs: How social interaction anxiety, zoom fatigue, relatedness, and demographics predict virtual meeting feature preferences. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports, 18*, 100673. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2025.100673

Lim, C., Ratan, R., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., Jeong, D., & Leith, A. P. (2025). Examining attitudes about the virtual workplace: Associations between Zoom fatigue, Impression management, and virtual meeting adoption intent. *PLOS One*. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0312354

Beyea, D., Lim, C., Lover, A., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Leith, A. P. (2025). Zoom fatigue in review: A meta-analytical examination of videoconferencing fatigue's antecedents. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports, 17*(100571). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2024.100571

Foxman, M., Beyea, D., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R. A., Chen, V. H. H., & Klebig, B. (2021). Beyond genre: Classifying virtual reality experiences. *IEEE Transactions on Games, 14*(3), 466–477. https://doi.org/10.1109/TG.2021.3119521

Leith, A. P., & Gheen, E. (2022). Twitch in the time of quarantine: The role of engagement in needs fulfillment. *Psychology of Popular Media, 11*(3), 275–280. https://doi.org/10.1037/ppm0000372

Leith, A. P. (2021). Parasocial cues: The ubiquity of parasocial relationships on Twitch. *Communication Monographs, 88*(1), 111–129. https://doi.org/10.1080/03637751.2020.1868544

Ratan, R. A., Fordham, J., Leith, A. P., & Williams, D. (2019). Women keep it real: Avatar gender choice in League of Legends. *Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking, 22*, 254–257. https://doi.org/10.1089/cyber.2018.0302

DeGroot, J. M., & Leith, A. P. (2018). R.I.P. Kutner: Parasocial grief following the death of a television character. *OMEGA — Journal of Death and Dying, 77*, 199–216. https://doi.org/10.1177/0030222815600450

Leith, A. P., Ratan, R. A., & Wohn, D. Y. (2016). The (de-)evolution of evolution games: Analyzing the accuracy of evolution depiction in video games. *Journal of Science Education and Technology, 25*, 655–664. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10956-016-9620-x

Editorials

Foxman, M., Ratan, R. A., Peña, J., Beyea, D., Leith, A. P., & Klebig, B. (2026). Editorial: Exploring meaningful extended reality (XR) experiences: Psychological, educational, and data-driven perspectives. *Frontiers in Virtual Reality, 7*, 1935335. https://doi.org/10.3389/frvir.2026.1935335

Beyea, D., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., Klebig, B., Leith, A. P., & Chen, V. H. H. (2025). Metaverse-mediated communication: A call for theory-driven XR research [Editorial]. *Journal of Media Psychology: Theories, Methods, and Applications, 37*(2), 61–63. https://doi.org/10.1027/1864-1105/a000465

Funding

External Funding (Awarded)

NSF FW-HTF-R Collaborative Research, PI, SIUE award (NSF 2128813). *Virtual Meeting Support for Enhanced Well-Being and Equity for Game Developers.* $70,458 to SIUE, one of four collaborative awards totaling $1,599,851 (Michigan State University, lead; University of Oregon; University of Wisconsin–Whitewater; SIUE); 10/2021 – 04/2025.

Internal Funding

Leith, A. P. (2025–2026). OER Faculty Incentive Program: Vibes to Variables (V2V) Courseware Umbrella. $7,792.36. SIUE Online Services & Educational Outreach.

Leith, A. P. (2023–2024). OER Faculty Incentive Program: MC 451 open textbook. $6,559.71. SIUE.

Leith, A. P. (2021–2022). New Faculty Incentive Program. $2,000. SIUE.

Contracts

Southern Illinois University Edwardsville. *MC 427 course-material development.* $3,000 (flat); payout Fall 2026.

Industry & Foundation Research Partnerships

Beyond Meet Space (BMS) Initiative. Cross-institutional research collective on virtual presence and remote work, founded ~2020. Industry and platform partners include game studios and the VRChat platform; institutional partners across multiple universities. Active research outputs in journals including *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, *PLOS One*, *IEEE Transactions on Games*, and *Frontiers in Communication*.

Graduate Mentoring & Student Supervision

Cross-unit mentoring at SIUE spanning Mass Communications, Applied Communication Studies, Integrative Studies, Environmental Sciences, and Psychology.

Master's Project / Thesis Committee Chair

- Michelle Poneleit, Integrative Studies. Oct 2025 – present.

Master's Project / Thesis Committee Member

- Gabriel Simpson, Mass Communications. Nov 2024 – May 2025.
- Maria Gomez Torne, Mass Communications. Nov 2024 – May 2025.
- Emonvuon Magdalene, Mass Communications. Jun 2024 – Jan 2025.
- Andrew Heaslet, Environmental Sciences (cross-unit). *Midwestern Climate Policymaking on Twitter: Policy Entrepreneurs and Framing in the Debate that Led to Illinois' Climate and Equitable Jobs Act*. May – Dec 2024.
- Abdurrahman Celik, Mass Communications. *#BrandWars on Instagram: A Deep Analysis of User Comments on Instagram to Have a Better Understanding About Competitive and Comparative Advertising on Social Media.* Aug 2023 – Jul 2024.
- Ashlyn Smith, Mass Communications. *Modernizing Advertising Techniques for Non-Profit Radio Stations with Social Media: The Case of WSIE.* Nov 2021 – Aug 2022.
- Kain Henson, Integrative Studies. *Sports Teams' Social Media Strategies and Audience Engagement*. Nov 2020 – Aug 2021.
- Rachel Berg, Integrative Studies. *The Rebranding of Skinn Fitness Aesthetics to Skinn Aesthetics.* Apr 2020 – May 2021.

Graduate Exam Committee

- Claire Chulka, Mass Communications. Feb – Apr 2024.
- Lenny Escarlet Montano Claure, Mass Communications. Jan – Apr 2021.

Directed Individual / Independent Study

- Amanda Cooper, Mass Communications. *Small Audience Streamer Gender Expectations, Pressures, and Behaviors on Twitch.tv.* Aug – Dec 2020.

URCA Mentor (SIUE Undergraduate Research and Creative Activities)

- Dallas Creech, Mass Communications. Aug – Dec 2020.
- Erin Gheen, Applied Communication Studies (cross-unit). Aug – Dec 2020. Coauthor on Leith & Gheen (2022), *Psychology of Popular Media*.
- Olivia Buente, Psychology (cross-unit). Aug – Dec 2020.
- Dakota Kasper, Mass Communications. Jan – May 2020.
- Samuel Baker, Psychology (cross-unit). Jan – May 2020. Coauthor on Leith & Baker (2020) NCA paper on machine-learning identification of racial harassment in Twitch chat.

Senior Assignment Supervision

- Thomas Yancey, Integrative Studies. *Thomas Yancey Website Portfolio.* Sep 2021 – Feb 2021.
- Stephanie Schrage, Integrative Studies. Jan – May 2020.

Intellectual Property & Technology Transfer (SIUE)

GearOut (formerly Control Room / The Cage). Equipment reservation and checkout platform for universities; deployed at SIUE as "MassComm Checkout." 155 files, 21.5K LoC, 57 API routes, 21 models. Sole developer (300+ hours). Disclosed via SIU System OTMIR (Office of Technology Management & Industry Relations); SIUE retains the IP. Licensed to SIM-DAD LLC through OTMIR, 2026. Repository private.

BMS Selective Muting Evaluation (with team). MSU Technologies-led Invention Disclosure submitted 2026-05-08; Alex as 1 of 8 contributors at 15% SIUE-affiliated contribution per SIU IP policy. Cross-institutional patent disclosure originating from FW-HTF-R research.

Technical & Methodological Skills

Methods. Experimental and survey design · content analysis with intercoder reliability · meta-analysis · equivalence testing · sentiment and NLP text analysis · large-scale social-media data collection · mixed-method case study · focus groups in VR.

Languages & environments. R (package authorship, Quarto/Bookdown) · Python · SQL / DuckDB · TypeScript / Next.js · Git.

Platforms & tooling. Social VR and XR research environments (VRChat) · virtual meeting platforms · local/offline LLM pipelines · reproducible research and courseware toolchains.

Accessibility. WCAG 2.1 AA remediation · tagged-PDF / PDF-UA workflows · Blackboard Ally compliance.

Open-Source Software & Datasets

Open-Source Software

- **Mass Communications Careers Dashboard** (SvelteKit) — 2025-present. github.com/AURA-Lab-SIUE/mc-careers-dashboard
- **v2v** (R package for reproducible course delivery; ships the Twitch teaching corpus and the pedagogical helpers introduced chapter by chapter in the V2V textbook, including `reliability()` for intercoder agreement and a colorblind-safe figure theme; component of the Vibes to Variables (V2V) courseware umbrella, an OER toolkit for teaching research methods to students new to statistics, methods, and coding; formerly *mccoursepack*/*coursepackR*) — 2025-present. github.com/AURA-Lab-SIUE/v2v-r
- **V2V Hub** (supplemental research methods course website; rebrand and redesign of the legacy Open Methods Hub site) — 2025-present. github.com/AURA-Lab-SIUE/v2v-hub
- **V2V Course Workspace** (VS Code and Git template repository giving students a version-controlled research workspace: journals, literature notes, codebook, and project drafts in one folder) — 2026-present. github.com/AURA-Lab-SIUE/v2v-workspace

Open Teaching Datasets

- **Twitch Chat and Stream Practice Corpus** (`twitch_chat_sample`, `twitch_streams_sample`): redistributable teaching sample of live-stream chat and channel metadata, 50 channels with 8 anchor channels, shipped in the `v2v` R package for classroom content-analysis work. Access: Open.

Research Datasets (restricted access; ToS/IRB governed)

- **Twitch Chat Logs** (Dec 17, 2018 – Jan 17, 2019): 117,943 channels; 321,189,309 messages. Access: Restricted.

- **VRChat Tweets** (Jan 16, 2014 – May 25, 2023): 1,434,367 original English-language tweets. Access: Restricted.
- **Remote Work Tweets** (April 2020 & April 2021): 1,409,966 tweets from 887,888 unique users. Access: Restricted.

Books & OER

Open Educational Resources

Leith, A. P. (2026). *Vibes to variables: A methods package for students new to research, stats, and code.* AURA Lab @ SIUE. https://aura-lab.siue.edu/v2v/

Fourteen-chapter open textbook in content-analytic research methods, published as an accessible website with a tagged PDF edition. Issued in two profiles from one source: an undergraduate edition (*Vibes to Variables*) and a graduate supplement (*Beyond Vibes*) surfaced through a reader-controlled toggle. Every figure is reproducible from shipped data, carries alternative text, and is colorblind-safe. Each chapter is additionally available as narrated audio. WCAG 2.1 AA conformant, verified by automated audit at 90 pages with zero violations. Supported by the `v2v` R package, the V2V Hub course site, and the V2V Course Workspace template.

Reviewed Book

Leith, A. P. (2024). *Quantitative research in mass communications: R and RStudio.* Bookdown. https://bookdown.org/alex_leith/mc451/

Book Chapters

Fordham, J., Leith, A. P., & Ratan. R. A. (2017). League of Legends: Summoning a league of their own. In J. Banks, R. Mejia, & A. Adams (Eds.), *100 greatest video game franchises* (pp. 102–104). Rowman & Littlefield.

Leith, A. P., & Fordham, J. (2017). Assassin's Creed: Leap of faith through historiophoty. In J. Banks, R. Mejia, & A. Adams (Eds.), *100 greatest video game franchises* (pp. 11–12). Rowman & Littlefield.

Leith, A. P., & Ratan, R. A. (2017). Super Smash Bros.: Fight with the one that brung ya. In J. Banks, R. Mejia, & A. Adams (Eds.), *100 greatest video game franchises* (pp. 178–180). Rowman & Littlefield.

Refereed Proceedings

Lim, C., Beyea, D., Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Klebig, B., & Ratan, R. (2025, January). The Hyperpersonal Model of Communication in virtual meetings: Exploring the roles of fatigue, social interaction anxiety, muting, and avatar use in meeting engagement. *Proceedings of the 58th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences.*

Milik, O., Jang, D., Foxman, M., Klebig, B., Beyea, D., Leith, A. P., & Ratan, R. (2024, November). Focusing on virtual groups: A method for focus group interviews in XR/VR group settings. *AoIR Selected Papers of Internet Research, 2024.*

Milik, O., Foxman, M., Jang, D., Lin, Q., Waier, J., Zheng, A., Bouzek, D., Klebig, B., Leith, A. P., Beyea, D., & Ratan, R. A. (2024, October). Beyond Meet Space: Running a focus group study in VR. *Proceedings of Meaningful Play 2024.* Pittsburgh, PA.

Key, L., Saqib, B., McDonald, W., Zheng, A., Lerner, K., Lover, A., Winn, B., Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., & Ratan, R. A. (2024, October). Designing a nondisruptive game mechanic for meetings in virtual reality. *Proceedings of Meaningful Play 2024.* Pittsburgh, PA.

Foxman, M., Bouzek, D., Lim, C., Ratan, R., Klebig, B., Leith, A. P., & Beyea, D. (2024, July). Making a virtual playground: Values-based game design in meeting platforms. *DiGRA 2024 Conference: Playgrounds.*

Lim, C., Foxman, M., Leith, A. P., Meshi, D., & Ratan, R. (2024, July). Wanting playfulness to counter fatigue from virtual meetings. *DiGRA 2024 Conference: Playgrounds.*

Foxman, M., Bouzek, D., Ratan, R. A., & Leith, A. (2023, June). Virtually Limited: Boundaries of Play in Virtual Reality Production. *DiGRA 2023 Conference: Limits and Margins of Games.*

Leith, A., Foxman, M., Onuche, M., Ratan, R., & Lim, C. (2023, June). Mixed Feelings and Realities: Joyful to Nauseating Sentiments about VR on Twitter. *DiGRA 2023 Conference: Limits and Margins of Games.*

Foxman, M., Leith, A. P., Beyea, D., Klebig, B., Chen, V. H. H., & Ratan, R. (2020, November). Virtual reality genres: Comparing preferences in immersive experiences and games. *CHI PLAY '20: Extended Abstracts* (pp. 237–241). ACM. https://doi.org/10.1145/3383668.3419881

Leith, A. P. (2019, October). Playing games for others: Constructing a gameplay livestreaming typology. *Proceedings of Meaningful Play 2018* (pp. 372–379). ETC Press. https://doi.org/10.17613/xtgds-c0853

Invited Talks

Leith, A. P., Freberg, K., Wall, M., & Dalton, S. (2020, May). How to teach digital and social media marketing well. Panel presented at the *Midwest Digital Marketing Conference.* St. Louis, MO.

Conference Papers (Selected)

Milik, O., Ratan, R., Chen, V., Pandita, S., Foxman, M., & Leith, A. P. (2025, June). Looking Beyond Meet Space: Presenting a Research Platform in VRChat. *International Communication Association 75th Annual Conference.* Denver, CO.

Leith, A. P., Lim, C., Foxman, M., Beyea, D., & Jeong, D. (2025, June). Stress and Coping in VRChat. *International Communication Association 75th Annual Conference.* Denver, CO.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Lim, C., & Beyea, D. (2025, June). What ASD finds in VRChat: The potential for VR to address communication barriers for individuals with Autism Spectrum Disorder. *ICA 75th Annual Conference.* Denver, CO.

Beyea, D., Lim, C., Lover, A., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Leith, A. P. (2024, June). Zoom fatigue? A meta-analytical examination of research on the antecedents of videoconferencing fatigue. *ICA 74th Annual Conference.* Gold Coast, QLD.

Foxman, M., Bouzek, D., Lim, C., & Leith, A. P. (2024, June). Playing from home: Identity, cohesion, and communication for remote game makers. *ICA 74th Annual Conference.* Gold Coast, QLD.

Foxman, M., Leith, A. P., Ratan, R., & Bouzek, D. (2023, May). Playfully Virtual: Finding Authentic Communication in Videoconferencing and Online Meetings. *ICA 73rd Annual Conference.* Toronto, ON.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Onuche, M., & Bouzek, D. (2023, May). Diffusion of gratification: The reception of VR as a modality for remote work and meetings. *ICA 73rd Annual Conference.* Toronto, ON.

Leith, A. P., Foxman, M., Ratan, R., & Lim, C. (2023, May). Feelings for meetings: A sentiment analysis of videoconferencing platforms a year apart. *ICA 73rd Annual Conference.* Toronto, ON.

Leith, A. P., & Baker, S. (2020, November). Cmonbruh, trihard: Using machine-learning to identify racial harassment in Twitch chat messages. *NCA 106th Annual Convention.*

Leith, A. P. (2020, May). Communicating closeness: Verbal immediacy as a predictor of parasocial relationships on Twitch. *ICA 70th Annual Conference.*

Leith, A. P. (2019, August). The affective messaging of gameplay livestream viewers. *Digital Games and Research Association Conference.* Kyoto, Japan.

Leith, A. P., Ratan, R. A., & Wohn, D. Y. (2013, June). The (de-)evolution of evolution games. *ICA 63rd Annual Conference.*

DeGroot, J. M., & Leith, A. P. (2011, November). R.I.P. Kutner: Parasocial relationships and grieving the death of a television character. *NCA 97th Annual Convention.*

Courses Taught

Southern Illinois University Edwardsville (Assistant/Associate Professor)

- **MC 590:** Independent Study in Mass Communications (Fall 2020)
- **MC 501:** Research Methods for Mass Communications (Fall 2024, Fall 2025)
- **MC 471:** Special Topics — Introduction to Data Analytics in Journalism and Mass Communications (Fall 2019)
- **MC 471:** Special Topics — Social Media Analytics (Spring 2024)
- **MC 451:** Research Methods in Mass Media (Spring 2021, Spring 2022 – Spring 2026)
- **MC 422:** Strategic Media Writing (Fall 2025 – Spring 2026)
- **MC 342:** Digital Imagery (Spring 2025)
- **MC 327:** Design and Writing for the World Wide Web (Fall 2019 – Spring 2023, Spring 2024)
- **MC 323:** Digital Publishing and Design (Spring 2023 – Fall 2023, Fall 2024 – Spring 2025)
- **FST 101:** Succeeding & Engaging at SIUE (Fall 2023)

Teaching Assistant — Michigan State University

COM 803: Intro to Quantitative Research Methods (Fall 2011) · TC 401: Social Media in Society (Fall 2013) · TC 401: Science Fiction, Communication, and Technology (Spring–Fall 2013) · MI 201: Introduction to Media and Information Technologies and Industries (Spring–Fall 2016) · MI 101: Understanding Media (Spring 2015 – Spring 2017)

Adjunct Instructor

McKendree University: JRN 372: Web and Print Publication Design (Spring 2012) · St. Louis College of Pharmacy: EN 3100: Professional Communication (Fall 2011 – Spring 2012) · SIUE: SPC 105: Public Speaking (Fall 2011), SPC 103: Interpersonal Communication (Fall 2010 – Fall 2011)

Curriculum Development

- **Vibes to Variables (V2V)** — OER courseware umbrella for teaching research methods to students new to statistics, methods, and coding. Funded twice by the SIUE OER Faculty Incentive Program. 2023 – present. Four integrated open components: the textbook, the `v2v` R package, the V2V Hub course site, and the V2V Course Workspace student template. Rebuilt in 2026 onto an original Twitch live-stream corpus, replacing the retired music dataset, and issued in paired undergraduate and graduate editions from a single source.
- **MC 451 and MC 501** — full Fall 2026 course build on the V2V system: 42 lecture decks, paired syllabi, and Blackboard cartridges, with the graduate course differentiated by depth rather than by additional technique.
- **MC 451** — authored the open textbook *Quantitative Research in Mass Communications: R and RStudio*; revised for modularity, 2024.

- **MC 471 Special Topics** — new course preparation, graduate and undergraduate sections, 2024.
- **MC 427** — course-material development under contract, Fall 2026.
- **Accessibility remediation** — MC 451 and MC 501 brought to 100% Blackboard Ally compliance, 2026; WCAG 2.1 AA conformance across the V2V materials, verified by automated audit of the rendered pages rather than the source.

Certifications & Professional Development

- **Designing Learner-Centered and Equitable Courses** — Association of College and University Educators (ACUE) microcredential, Cohort I. Six-module online program completed over eight weeks, covering clear learning outcomes, aligned assessment, and equitable grading practice. March–April 2026.
- **Core Curriculum** — National Center for Faculty Development & Diversity (NCFDD). 2023.

Professional Memberships

- International Communication Association (ICA) — Game Studies Division
- National Communication Association (NCA)
- Digital Games Research Association (DiGRA)

Service

Guest Editorships

Both arising from the Meaningful XR conference; each is a single special issue / research topic, not a standing masthead appointment.

- Guest Editor, ***Frontiers in Virtual Reality***. Research Topic: *Exploring Meaningful Extended Reality (XR) Experiences: Psychological, Educational, and Data-Driven Perspectives.* 2026.
- Guest Co-Editor, ***Journal of Media Psychology*** (Hogrefe). Special Issue: *Metaverse-Mediated Communication.* 2023 – 2025.

Research Culture & Convening (cross-unit / interdisciplinary)

- Co-Founding Organizer, **Meaningful XR** (meaningfulxr.org). Beyond Meet Space initiative; annual conference convening researchers and practitioners around virtual presence, social VR, and mediated communication. 2023 – present. Stanford convening Jun 2023 – May 2024.
- **ICA Game Studies Division**, Student & Early Career Representative. Spring 2022 – Summer 2024.
- **ICA Game Studies Division**, Board Member. Oct 2021 – Jun 2024.
- **ICA**, Discord Moderator. Oct 2021 – present. Community-facing role moderating year-round scholarly discussion across ICA divisions.

Peer Review — Journals

Behaviour & Information Technology · Communication and Sports · Communication Monographs · Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking · Death & Dying · Games & Culture · Information & Management · International Journal of Communication · Journal of Communication Technology · Journal of Gaming & Virtual Worlds · Mass Communication & Society · Media Psychology · Psychology of Popular Media · Technology, Mind, & Behavior

Peer Review — Conferences

ACM SIGCHI · AEJMC · CHI PLAY · DiGRA · Global Fusion · HICSS · ICA · Meaningful Play/XR · NCA

Departmental Service (SIUE)

- Program Coordinator, Faculty Discord Server (Dec 2023 – present). Department-internal cross-unit convening space for faculty.
- Technology Committee, Chair (Apr 2024 – present).
- Grant Committee, Member (Feb 2024 – present).
- ACEJMC Reaccreditation Committee, Member (Sep 2022 – Jan 2024).
- Mass Communications Week, Chair (Spring 2021 – Spring 2023). Annual department research-and-industry convening event.
- Website Committee, Member (Sept 2021 – Apr 2024). Merged into the Technology Committee on its creation.
- Library Liaison (Aug 2020 – May 2024).
- Global Fusion Conference Committee, Member (Apr – Nov 2020).

College Service (SIUE)

- Program Review Committee, International Studies (Sept – Dec 2023).

University Service (SIUE)

- Search Committee Member, School of Engineering Dean Search (Spring 2026 – present).
- Task Force Member, Engagement in Asynchronous Classes (Summer 2020).
- Search Committee Member, Director of Student Financial Aid (Spring 2020 – Fall 2020).